

Crystal Clear - full project proposal

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Why this document exists. The form allows 250 words for the concept and 100 for each other answer. This project has a physical build, two public activities, a song produced on another continent, a film shot on location, a documented content strand, and travel from Australia. The detailed proposal is formally due **October/November 2027**; this is an early version, offered now so the jury can see that the schedule request below is a production decision. **Everything here is open to revision at Stage 2**, which is where it belongs.

1 · The proposition in one paragraph

A **spatial ArtXScience work** in which a visitor walks through the translation of a scientific finding into contemporary pop: first the research as material, then the translation made visible, then a timed screening of the finished film. The research is Shabarova et al. 2021 on Jiřická Pond, in which **dissolved nutrients return to predisturbance levels before microbial composition recovers**. One new pop song is written from that asymmetry, produced to release standard, and released publicly. **The installation is the artwork. The film is a station inside it.**

1a · What this continues from Kangaroo Time, and where it steps further

Kangaroo Time is the best existing example of this practice, and it is what the jury will watch. It came out of my doctoral research, won the **AAAS Dance Your PhD Overall Winner 2024**, and reached **238 media features across five continents**. What it proves is already relevant here: that a real finding can carry a pop song, that a cast drawn from several communities can be directed on location, and that the result travels.

This project continues three things from it and steps further on two.

Continues

A real finding as the source

A cast of local people, paid, on location

The polysemic element

not a theme about science, a specific published result
the same working method, moved to South Bohemia
“kangaroo time” and “mates” there; “coming back”
here

Steps further

1 · Science enters the sound itself.

Until now, science has entered my music through **lyrics, concepts and movement**, as in *Kangaroo Time*. This will bring science **into the sound itself**: recordings become textures and starting points for rhythm, melody and arrangement.

(That sentence is from my artsACT application for bioacoustic curation, lodged 22 September 2026. It describes the next step in the practice, and this residency is where it meets a real research site.) Here the material is the scientists’ own: water, wind, sampling, the bench, the instruments, and the patterns they point at. **Not illustration laid over a track. The track built from it.**

2 · The film is made to music industry standards, not to a competition brief.

□ *Kangaroo Time* was made **for the Dance Your PhD competition**, and it carries what that brief asks for, including **explanatory text on screen**. A music video released into the industry does not explain itself.

So this film carries no explanatory text on screen. The science is legible through the installation, through the credits, and through the work itself.

- **One deliberate exception, and it is the scientists' call.** A captioned cut may serve the installation better than the clean release cut, because Station 2 is where the translation is meant to be readable. **We would discuss with the scientists whether they want that version**, and if so both cuts exist: the clean one for release, the annotated one for the room.
- **The direction of travel:** *Kangaroo Time* made science legible to a broad audience through a competition format. **This is more arty and more industry at once** - further into the sci pop I am developing, and further into the standards a pop release is actually held to.

1b · The method, named

This project runs on a method I have developed and written up, rather than on inspiration.

- **The Interconnected Narrative** is a four-step compositional method for translating real research into an artistic product: **theme** □ **parallel mapping of the scientific and the socio-cultural narrative** □ **polysemic elements** □ **artistic product**. Its theoretical contribution is the **polysemic element**: *one unit of the artwork legible inside both narratives at once, literally true in each*.

- **It is not metaphor.** Metaphor describes one thing as another. A polysemic element is one form carrying two meanings that are both literally true. (*Method paper in preparation; the practice it belongs to, sci pop, is defined in [Zenodo 10.5281/zenodo.21387515](https://zenodo.org/record/105281/zenodo.21387515).*)

Worked once already: in *Kangaroo Time*, made from [my doctoral research](#), the polysemic elements were “**kan-garoo time**” and “**mates**” - each true in the behavioural-ecology reading and in the everyday Australian one.

Here the polysemic element is coming back. In the scientific narrative it is reassembly toward a predisturbance state, on unequal clocks. In the socio-cultural narrative it is a person returning to a place. **One phrase, both literally true**, which is why it can carry a pop chorus without flattening the science.

- **And that is the point of Station 2 in the installation.** The connector shows the polysemic element being made: the reading, the mapping, and the decisions that came out of it.

1c · Authorship: who leads, and who is brought in

Dr WELI is the lead artist on this project. He holds, and does not delegate:

Creative direction	the concept, and every decision about what the work is and is not
The science reading	he reads the primary literature unaided, writes the annotated cards, and runs the paper-to-score sessions. He is a quantitative ecologist with a PhD and a first-authored paper in <i>Behavioral Ecology</i>
Songwriting	lyrics, melody, structure. The hook and what it must hold up against
Performance	he is the vocalist and the artist on the record
Direction of the film	the script, the artistic concept, the shot list, and the central choreography , which he prepares and teaches
The installation concept	the three stations, what is shown at each, and how the science reads as science before it reads as pop
Body preparation	his own, and the preparation work with the ensemble

Specialists are engaged at specific moments, for a specific standard. The residency asks for an outcome presentable at a European festival. Certain components require a professional who does that work every week, and naming them is how the quality is guaranteed:

specialist	engaged for	why not the lead artist
Music producer (Forbes Street Studios, Sydney)	3 studio days across Jun to Aug 2027	The deliverable is a record at release standard . A producer who works in the genre daily delivers a mix and master that survives next to commercial pop. WELI writes and performs; the producer engineers and finishes
Film crew and editor (Czech, local)	2 shoot days plus on-site edit, Sep/Oct 2027	WELI directs. A professional camera operator and editor deliver the image quality a festival screening needs, and a local crew knows the locations and the permissions
Movement lead (České Budějovice)	preparation, 2 shoot days, the 2027 public lab	□ WELI creates the central choreography . The movement lead adapts it to local bodies , runs the ensemble in rehearsal, and brings the cast and the local network. A visiting artist cannot do that from outside
Dancers , 3, local and paid	2 shoot days	The work is made with people from that place. This is the community participation, and it is paid
AV and installation technician (local, or the venue's own AV staff)	build, commissioning, and the festival run	□ This is the capability WELI does not hold . Screens, listening points, projection, sound and safe daily operation in a public venue are a trade. Funded from the start rather than assumed
Czech language adviser	the refrain and accessible captions	So the work is legible to its own local audience, tested by someone who speaks it

□ **The pattern, stated plainly:** WELI leads the creative and research direction; named specialists deliver the technical components. **Nobody on that list makes an artistic decision about the work.**

2 · □ The one thing we are asking the programme to agree

We propose to hold the first residency period (February/March 2027) remotely, and to take that on-site month in September/October 2027 instead. We are asking; the programme decides.

The reason is a production dependency:

The song has to exist before the film can be shot, and the film has to exist before the installation can be built.

If the first on-site month falls in February 2027, it happens before there is a song, so the visit produces conversation and field recordings and no footage. The second required on-site month is **March 2028**, which the call already fills with *install, run of exhibition, de-install and a 5-10 day festival*. **There is no room in that month to also direct a shoot with a local cast.** Attempting it would put the exhibition opening at risk, and that is the one date that cannot move.

What we propose instead

period	mode	why it works
Jan to Aug 2027	remote	Kick-off, all scientist exchange, the material request, songwriting and full production in Sydney. The call's own Phase 2 is <i>"online and on-site exchange"</i> , so remote exchange is already the model
Sep/Oct 2027	on site, up to 1 month	Arrive with the finished song and a booked crew. Shoot the film with local dancers and consenting researchers, edit on site, run the 2027 public activity, and meet the city properly
Nov 2027 to Feb 2028	remote	Written proposal, film finishing, fabrication, maintenance manual
Mar 2028	on site, up to 1 month	Install, open, second public activity, document, de-install. Nothing competing for the month

The plain arithmetic, stated rather than buried

The call sets the requirement itself: *"required travels are 2-5 trips to Budweis; 2 trips to Ars Electronica"*, funded up to **EUR 3,000**. □ **From Sydney, only the bottom of that range is fundable.** WELI lives in Sydney. A return Sydney to Prague fare sits around **EUR 1,100** at the low end, so **two crossings consume the allowance almost exactly** once airport transfers, the Prague to České Budějovice rail and the České Budějovice to Linz rail visits are counted. A stress case with higher fares and unprovided festival lodging reaches roughly **EUR 4,000**. **A third crossing from Australia does not fit under any booking discipline we can apply, and we will not budget as though it does.**

□ **So this proposal is the minimum compliant reading of the programme's own specification: two stays in Budweis, with both required Ars Electronica visits made by rail from Budweis inside those stays.** Everything the call requires still happens, at the bottom of the range the call sets.

□ **One item to confirm early.** The call covers **accommodation for a one-month stay in České Budějovice from a separate budget.** Which of the two stays that applies to changes the subsistence arithmetic above, so it is worth settling in Round 2 rather than assuming.

So the request is two stays: September 2027 and March 2028, with the film shot during the September stay, the song finished and mastered before that flight, and everything before September run remotely.

If the programme requires the February/March presence, there are two honest routes and no third. Either the September shoot becomes a **third** crossing, in which case **the travel allowance is short and an additional confirmed travel contribution is needed**, or the first stay is connected to a family trip to Brazil in August 2027 and flown **Brazil to Prague instead of Sydney to Prague**, which does fit the allowance. **We would rather settle this at application stage than discover it in 2028.**

3 · The four programme phases, and what we do in each

Phase 1 · Kick-off online and on-boarding - early 2027 (Jan to Feb)

Their goal: introduce the programme, meet the members, get to know the city and facilities, co-design the collaboration framework, brainstorm directions.

we do	output
Attend the online kick-off. Meet the residency members, the ČB2028 team, Ars Electronica and the local stakeholder	relationships opened
Read the group's literature. One annotated card per paper , marking observation, inference, analogy and open question	cards shared with the scientists for correction
A guided remote tour of the city, venue and facilities with the ČB2028 team, recorded, so the installation is designed against a real space	venue notes and measurements
Co-design the collaboration framework: what each party gives, what each needs, how often we meet	written framework, agreed
Issue the material request (section 5)	request sent
□ Content: 2 pieces - what a pond in South Bohemia has to do with a pop song; the annotated-card method	2 of 15

Phase 2 · Online and on-site exchange - mid 2027 (Mar to Oct)

Their goal: continue the exchange remotely, develop the outcome, work on community engagement. Closes with the written proposal, Oct/Nov 2027.

we do	when	output
Fortnightly online exchange with the scientists. Paper-to-score sessions by video : they walk through the figures, we test what a pattern could carry	Mar to Jun	decisions and disagreements recorded
Their field material arrives and is catalogued on receipt with full metadata (section 5)	Mar to May	credited source library
Songwriting , then production at Forbes Street Studios, Sydney	Jun to Aug	finished master
Demo exchange : the scientists hear drafts and flag where an analogy stops being accurate	Jul	revised arrangement
Contract the movement lead, who then brings the cast; contract crew and language adviser	Jul to Aug	team booked before travel
ON SITE, Sep/Oct : film shoot, 2 days, local dancers and consenting researchers. Edit on site. Public listening and movement lab (required 2027 activity). Venue walkthrough for the installation	Sep/Oct	footage, first cut, lab documented, install plan against the real room
Written proposal with updated outcome, production outline, budget detail, tasks and tech rider	Oct/Nov	their deliverable, met
□ Content: 8 pieces - material arriving; a pattern becoming a rhythm; studio production; the lab; the shoot; a scientist reacting to a draft		10 of 15

Phase 3 · Artwork production - early 2028

Their goal: produce the artwork, adjust for feasibility, develop maintenance manuals.

we do	output
Finish the film: colour, captions, accessible subtitles in Czech and English	screening master
Fabricate the installation: structure, printed material, mounting	built and test-assembled
Build the entry soundscape from the field material	stereo or multichannel bed
Rough-cut checkpoint: the scientists check accuracy before lock	signed-off accuracy
Maintenance manual: daily start-up and shut-down, failure modes, who to call, spares	manual delivered
Feasibility adjustment gate: if the venue cannot host the full path, the contingency in section 4 applies	decision recorded
□ Content: 3 pieces - fabrication; the accuracy checkpoint; the manual	13 of 15

Phase 4 · Ars Biologica Festival - spring 2028

Their goal: install, open, host one more public engagement activity, document, de-install.

On European spring: meteorological spring is **1 March to 31 May**; astronomical spring runs **about 20 March to 21 June**. The call places the third stay in **March 2028**, so we have planned to March and will follow the festival's confirmed dates.

we do	output
Install and commission, with the AV technician	work running
Opening, then daily operation across the 5 to 10 day festival	exhibition open
Second public engagement activity: a walk-through and conversation with willing scientists and the local collaborators, comparing what people said in the 2027 lab with what the work became	required 2028 activity, met
Document the work and the public activity	images and video for ČB2028
De-install, settle credits, hand over	closed
□ Content: 2 pieces - the opening; the song released publicly	15 of 15

4 · The installation, described properly

The visitor walks the translation. Three stations, one continuous path, continuous sound.

The order a visitor meets things, stop by stop. Six stops sit across the three built stations, so the route below is what the budget's three stations actually deliver.

stop	what is there	station
1	The fieldwork. Images of the work being done, from the research team and from our own time with them. You meet the people and the place before any result.	1
2	The publication. Their paper, displayed and readable. The peer-reviewed science itself, credited, in the room.	1
3	What they sent us. The bioacoustic recordings, photographs, video and documented patterns, playable and viewable as they arrived, before anything was done to them.	1
4	How we worked. The creative process documented: photographs, short videos, the writing, lyric drafts and visual scores, beside the material that informed each one. Printed brochures the visitor keeps and uses, covering the process, what sci pop is, and the different ways research can enter music.	2
5	The mini cinema session. A timed, captioned screening of the finished music film in a controlled listening space. The visitor arrives having already heard the pond it came from.	3
6	What happened next. If the song is released by the festival, the room closes with the release data, the media coverage and the impact. The last thing a visitor sees is the evidence that the work carries on past the gallery door.	3

□ **Stop 6 is deliberate.** This practice has a measurable afterlife: *Kangaroo Time* drew 238 or more media features across five continents and 154,766 lifetime views. If this song has an afterlife by March 2028, the room says so with data, and the visitor leaves knowing the work did not stop at the gallery door.

Station 1 · What we were given

Listening points carry the field recordings from the research sites, so a visitor hears the actual water, wind, sampling and bench sound before anything else. On mounted panels and **screens:** microscopy and field imagery from the scientists, the plots and the patterns they pointed at, and the printed finding in their own words.

□ **Every item carries the name of the scientist who produced it.** The credit is part of the display, not a line at the exit. A short printed legend separates **observation**, **inference** and **artistic analogy**, using the same three labels as the annotated cards from Phase 1.

This is the science, as science, credited.

Station 2 · What we did with it, and how

□ **This station is the connector.** It shows, item by item, how the paper became a song and a film.

Screens and listening points run side by side so the visitor can compare the source with what it became:

what is shown	what it connects
The annotated cards , with the scientist's corrections visible A pattern, then the sound it became	the reading of the paper, and where they said an inference was actually an analogy a plot or a field recording playing next to the rhythmic or melodic decision it produced
The lyric drafts , with the lines that changed after the 2027 public lab marked The arrangement notes	the lyrical conversion of the finding, and what the local audience changed the non-lyrical conversion: which motif is interrupted, which phase leads briefly, which voice reassembles late
The demo versions the scientists heard , with their responses The video script and concept boards	the accuracy gate, in the artists' and the scientists' own words how the same finding produced the film's images and movement
Where an analogy was rejected	shown, with the reason

This is the ArtXScience work itself, which is usually invisible. It is the reason the installation goes beyond a screen: the translation is the exhibit.

Station 3 · The cinema session

A seated screening area. **The finished music video plays on a timed loop, a short session every few minutes**, the way a museum runs a film room, with proper sound. Between sessions the screen holds a still and the entry soundscape carries.

This is where the song arrives, as a song.

□ **Why this shape.** The call asks for a spatial work that goes **beyond screen-based exploration**. A film shown on panels is still a film. **A walk-through of how a scientific finding became a pop song is a spatial work in which the screen is one station.** It also puts the residency's actual subject, the collaboration, on display.

Deliberately low-risk: freestanding venue-approved structure, one projector, one sound system, no live water, no cultured organisms, no real-time data feed, no suspended rig, no wet flooring, no equipment operated by researchers.

Contingency: if the venue cannot host the full path, Stations 1 and 2 collapse into a single printed and sounded wall, and Station 3 stays. The logic survives at a smaller footprint.

It also stands alone: the song and film circulate online after the exhibition, with accessible captions and the same printed legend.

5 · Where we need the scientists, precisely

□ **Step one is a conversation, and no artistic decision precedes it.** We sit down with the researchers and ask them to tell us about their research in their own words, then ask the question that actually decides this project: *of everything you have found, what would you most want a stranger to know?* We are listening for findings that speak to what this call names: **climate emergence, sustainable agriculture, geoengineering, permaculture, water resource management, and the broader ecological impacts that reach the people living nearby.** Out of that conversation we choose the research to work with, or the combination of findings, and WELI explains what he can and cannot do with each one. **The scientists decide what their science says. WELI decides how it sounds.**

Then the paper is read for the emotional connector: the central problem, meaning the real-life pain the research addresses, and the sentence where the finding already carries a human feeling. The worked example on a real Centre paper is at §1b and on the public proposal page.

And after the material arrives, a second conversation: why did you choose these? What made you pick this recording, what are we looking at in this image, what is remarkable about it to you. That is where we learn which patterns are meaningful and which are noise, and where a misreading is caught before it reaches a lyric.

what we ask	when	why only they can give it
The research-selection conversation: tell us about the work, and what you would most want a stranger to know, against the call's focus areas	Jan to Feb 2027	this is the decision the whole project rests on , and it is theirs to inform
Correct the annotated cards: is this an observation, an inference or my analogy?	Jan to Feb 2027	it is their work, and this is the accuracy foundation everything else sits on
A curated field pack: 30 to 60 seconds each of water, wind, sampling equipment and site ambience; photographs of the actual site, research objects and permitted microscope material; an annotated plot showing a scientifically meaningful pattern	Feb to Apr 2027	they are at the sites, and they choose which actors, spaces and methods matter
One or two sentences on cultural association: who works at the site, its name, local uses	Feb to Apr 2027	it comes from people who know the place
Paper-to-score sessions by video: walk us through the figures and the two flood timelines; name three facts that cannot be distorted	Mar to Jun 2027	the constraints have to come from them
The why-these-materials conversation: walk us through what you sent and why you chose each item	Apr to Jun 2027	only they know which pattern is meaningful and which is noise
Demo exchange: hear drafts, say where an analogy stops being accurate	Jul 2027	the only test that matters for the science half
Appear on camera, if willing	Sep/Oct 2027	optional, consented, never assumed
Rough-cut accuracy checkpoint	Jan/Feb 2028	last gate before lock
Join the 2028 public conversation, if willing	Mar 2028	optional

□ **The scientists are co-thinkers, not final fact-checkers and not assumed performers.** Any one of them can propose an unexpected sonic, visual or movement form, and Dr Dindhoria defines a contribution from his current research rather than being assigned a paper he did not author.

What the project offers them: an encounter between their work and music listeners and local residents, **without asking them to endorse literal microbial characters or to perform in a video.**

□ **No researcher is asked to make a new recording on demand.** We request what already exists.

Conditions, written now rather than assumed: named credit on every piece that uses their material; **explicit permission before any use**, since scientific imagery and recordings belong to them and the institute; **metadata**

recorded with every file (date, location, recordist, instrument, whether processed, permission to publish, image licence, consent for identifiable voices, agreed credit).

□ **We do not ask them to record specially on unpaid time**, and we do not assume their work produces audible organism sounds. **If the archive is not available**, we record at permitted accessible sites and label that material accurately as an artistic layer, **never as Jiřická data**.

6 · Content creation as a core activity

The call requires: “*share updates on social media and provide České Budějovice 2028 with images of the residency process.*” We treat that as **a strand of the work with its own budget line**.

□ **Fifteen short pieces across the residency**. The number is deliberate: it is what WELI settled on for a comparable single-song fellowship, for the stated reason that **fifteen reads as feasible for a one-song project where thirty does not**.

phase	pieces	what they show
1 · Kick-off	2	what a South Bohemian pond has to do with a pop song; the annotated-card method
2 · Exchange	8	field material arriving; a pattern becoming a rhythm; production at the studio; the public lab; the shoot; a scientist reacting to a draft
3 · Production	3	fabrication; the accuracy checkpoint; the maintenance manual
4 · Festival	2	the opening; the song released
	15	

All with **accessible captions**. Stills and process images delivered to ČB2028 on an agreed schedule rather than only at the end. **Nothing featuring a person is published without their consent**.

6a · Who we want to work with, named

□ **Nothing below is booked, contacted for this project, or quoted**. These are the specific companies and people we would approach, with the evidence for why, so the jury can see the plan is built against real local capacity rather than a wish.

role	who, and the evidence	what must be requested
Exhibition design and fabrication lead	□ ACTPRO, České Budějovice (B. Smetany 1465/25). A family business doing conceptual design and physical manufacture of interactive exhibitions. Their listed work includes the “Water” exhibition for the Czech Academy of Sciences (2020) and the permanent natural science exhibition at the Jihočeské Museum here in České Budějovice (2019), plus the National Museum and the National Gallery. They have already built a water exhibition for the host’s own academy.	A written design, fabrication, installation, maintenance and de-installation estimate for a small temporary work. Ask for venue conditions and a split between their own staff and any AV subcontractor
Music film	Tomáš Kříž Production, České Budějovice, filming nationwide. □ They publish rates: CZK 12,000 for a shoot of up to 6 hours including post-production, CZK 1,000 per additional hour, CZK 4,000 for a second camera operator, transport at 8 CZK/km from České Budějovice. Those rates price other formats, so they anchor rather than quote this film. Also Jakub Jeřábek as an alternative	A two-day creative music film: lighting, camera, sound, edit, grade, delivery, integration of scientist-supplied footage, travel, revision rounds and licensing
Movement	Taneční studio No Limit, České Budějovice, a non-profit running since 2011, teaching hip hop, urban, locking, house, dancehall, whacking and vogue to adults as well as children, a Czech Dance Organization member with 2025 championship titles, supported by the city. □ Street styles are the vocabulary of contemporary pop video. Also the host’s own <i>Dance for My City</i> network	One choreographer and three adult performers: preparation, two rehearsals, the 2027 workshop and two shooting days. Individual fee splits, buyout and release terms, and any VAT
Song production	Forbes Street Studios, Woolloomooloo, Sydney. Their terms identify the studio as owned by Universal Music Australia. □ A booking makes them a supplier, not a confirmed project partner, and not a Universal release	One original song: producer, vocal sessions, revisions, mix, master and stems, with all applicable taxes and rights
AV supply and operation	A regional AV supplier, chosen with the exhibition lead and the host. □ Do not present a one-day event hire tariff as the cost of a festival run	Projector, media player, screens, listening hardware, speakers, cabling, tests, delivery, operator needs, damage and insurance, for the full exhibition period

role	who, and the evidence	what must be requested
Czech language and liaison	To identify, with the ČB2028 team	Refrain, captions, credits, releases and community contact

□ **On the record:** an earlier attempt to contact Still Production through its web form was automatically rejected. **No enquiry or quote from that company exists, and nothing here implies otherwise.**

7 · The budget

€15,000 production, proposed against the cap. Two lines carry published prices; every other line is a planning figure and is marked. The costed budget with written quotes is the **Stage 2** deliverable.

#	line	€	costing assumption and decision rule
1	Recorded pop single, Sydney, 3 days	3,020	Forbes Street: Demo Day (concept and translation day) + Pop Single Package. A\$4.884 inc GST = EUR 3.019 at 1,6177. Both LIST PRICES. Third day is the concept day and is priced.
2	Czech installation designer and lead	1,600	Ring-fenced professional role: concept against the real venue, measurements, route and screening design, drawings, venue liaison, safe build, install, de-install, maintenance guide.
3	Full-run AV: screens, listening points, projection, sound, labour	2,100	HIGH RISK. Full exhibition duration, not a one-day event tariff. Seek a written host equipment contribution; do not double-count a host-owned device as paid rental.
4	Czech music film: 2 shoot days, second operator, edit, grade	2,300	Anchor: Tomas Kriz Production publishes CZK 12.000 per 6h shoot with post and CZK 4.000 for a second operator. That arithmetic gives ~EUR 1.470 for two days. A music film needs lighting, grade, scientist-footage integration and revision rounds, so the line sits above the anchor.

#	line	€	costing assumption and decision rule
5	Movement lead and 3 paid adult performers	1,700	Choreographer plus three adults: preparation, two rehearsals, the 2027 workshop and two shooting days. Individual fee splits and release terms to be agreed.
6	Structure, surfaces, fabrication, fire treatment	800	Freestanding venue-approved supports and mounted print. Trim surface count if the quote exceeds.
7	Fifteen short process videos	700	Assembly, captions and exports from approved material. WELI handles capture and editorial direction.
8	2027 public lab and 2028 engagement	550	Local facilitation and room consumables beyond the performer line. Host venue contribution to be confirmed, never assumed.
9	Czech language, liaison, access and subtitling	650	Adviser and translator for community contact, captions, credits and releases. Czech and English.
10	Research material licences and rights	250	Permissions and field-image handling. Scientists are NOT assumed to produce custom material unpaid.
11	Contingency	1,330	8.9% against actual quotes, AV run length, and safety changes. Controlled by the lead artist.
	TOTAL	15,000	sums exactly to the cap, checked by script

Arithmetic: 3,020 + 1,600 + 2,100 + 2,300 + 1,700 + 800 + 700 + 550 + 650 + 250 + 1,330 = **15,000**.

□ **The largest unsupported figures are the full-run AV, the film and the installation lead.** They are negotiating targets. **If real bids force cuts, simplify the shoot scope, the equipment and the surface count first. Preserve, in this order: payment for the performers, accessibility, and an experienced exhibition lead.**

Reference rate 24 Sep 2026: 1 EUR = 1.6177 AUD · 1 EUR = 24.5 CZK. Not locked; re-check before any commitment.

What is already covered and costs nothing extra: the **scientist exchange itself** - the online kick-off, the fortnightly paper-to-score sessions, the demo exchange, the rough-cut checkpoint and all correspondence - sits inside the **€6,000 artist fee** and needs no production line. The same is true of the annotated cards, the material request, the written proposal, and the lead artist's own songwriting, direction and performance.

Where the money sits: installation €4,200 (28%), the largest block because it is the deliverable · **song €2,960 (20%)** · **paid local people €2,500 (17%)** · film €2,200 (15%) · community and access €1,250 (8%) · content and documentation €1,000 (7%) · contingency €590 (4%).

Artist fee €6,000 and **travel up to €3,000** are separate in the call.

Travel, against the €3,000: two return flights Sydney to Prague. March is the cheapest month of the year at about [A\\$1,321 return](#) (about €801); the annual average is A\$1,543 (about €935). Prague airport to České Budějovice is [about €10 by bus](#). **Both Ars Electronica trips are overland:** České Budějovice to Linz is [€9 to €14 by bus, 1h25](#). Two returns plus ground transport is **€1,697 to €1,966**, leaving **€1,034 to €1,303** for subsistence against roughly €480 needed. □ **The FAQ states there is no additional travel budget for applicants from other continents,** which is why the plan uses two crossings. *Declared rate 27 Sep 2026: 1 EUR = 1.65 AUD. Not locked; to be re-checked at booking.*

Rate instruments, named: WELI's own time is the NAVA independent-contractor Researcher line at **A\$85/hr**. □ **That is not a lever here, since the call fixes the fee at €6,000,** which covers roughly 116 hours across a 15-month project. Czech collaborators are governed by **no published instrument** and are negotiated. **Superannuation:** no Australian performer is engaged, so no super line falls due; if one is added for the recording, it becomes a line and not a rounding. Czech engagements carry Czech statutory on-costs, **not yet established**.

8 · Eligibility and logistics

Based in Sydney, Australia. Italian citizen, eligible to work and travel in the EU with no visa, permit or sponsorship. Italian passport valid to **December 2033**. The applicant's location creates no administrative cost or risk for the programme.

More than 5 years of professional creative practice, with a dated public record. The practice and the science have run together throughout:

when	what	where it can be checked
2017 to 2021	Sang and performed through the doctorate	his own account; the performing was continuous, and the first <i>independent releases</i> came later
before Sep 2021	Field photography during doctoral fieldwork	□ a photograph he took at the study site is published as Figure 2 of his 2021 ANU thesis, p.15, credit line “Image credits: Weliton Menário Costa”. Thesis PDF
Oct 2023	The Photography Project shot, WELI as concept and creative director	released 2024; credits at _Pool-Ideas/Photography-Project/README.md
2023	First independent music releases	APRA AMCOS writer membership since 2023
2024	<i>Kangaroo Time</i> , AAAS Dance Your PhD Overall Winner	public

Counted from the doctorate that is roughly nine years; counted with the full scientific training that feeds the work, sixteen. Either reading clears the five-year floor, and the 2021 thesis credit is the one a panel can verify in a single click.

Prior science collaboration: PhD in ecology and evolution (ANU), first-authored in *Behavioral Ecology* 34(6):1002-1012, and *Kangaroo Time* came out of his own doctoral research. AAAS Dance Your PhD **Overall Winner 2024**, 238 media features across five continents.

□ **Why the one-month block suits a distant applicant.** An artist based in Europe could visit weekly. He cannot. A stay of up to one month means each crossing delivers a **full month of concentrated on-site work** rather than a short visit.

8a · Production dependencies, stated so they can be checked now

The build only works if these hold, and they are the host's to confirm rather than ours to assume:

what	who confirms
Adequate floor area, power , and enough darkness for projection	venue
Exhibition dates, security, and permitted sound level	organiser
Fire treatment requirements for any fabric or surface, and insurance	organiser and venue
A safe freestanding design signed off	the exhibition lead
Rental equipment quoted for the entire run , not as a one-day event tariff	AV supplier
Whether any host-owned equipment is available, in writing	host

The €15,000 model assumes three stations, screens and listening points, and one projector. If a local designer shows this cannot be safe and legible within the cap, **reduce the surface count and keep the visitor's path and the sound perspective.**

Credit terms, agreed before anyone starts

Music producer	arrangement and technical production with WELI, vocal recording, mix, master, separable stems. □ A co-writing credit arises only if separately agreed in writing for an actual contribution
Choreographer and performers	adapt and perform WELI's movement vocabulary, with paid rehearsal and filming time. Choreographic contribution credited
Filmmaker	camera, location planning, logistics, edit and colour against WELI's script and approvals. Copyright and usage terms agreed
Exhibition designer and AV technician	translate WELI's visitor sequence into a safe layout and specification, with design and technical credits
Scientists	interpret their own findings, help select authorised source material, advise at three checkpoints, and receive accurate scientific and material credits. □ No implied composition, lyric or film authorship

9 · What we are not claiming

- **No collaborator is contracted.** Forbes Street Studios has not been approached for this project. The movement lead, cast, crew, AV technician and language adviser are **to identify**.
- **No quote is in hand.** Two published prices are linked; everything else is a planning figure.
- **No scientist has agreed to anything** beyond what the residency partnership itself establishes.

- **The A&R review and distribution offered by Forbes Street are optional add-ons**, outside the package price, and they are **not** in this budget.
- **The venue has not been surveyed.** The installation is designed to a described space and will be redesigned against the real one during the September 2027 stay.
- **Jiřická Pond is a small forest pond.** The work will show that site and place it beside, rather than equate it to, the managed fishponds of the region.
- **The authors leave open** whether the resilience they describe persists as weather extremes intensify. The work carries that question and does not answer it.